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the crowd got a chance to come close to their favourite cricketers and click selfies, those were busy days for venue staff who had to clear the way. "It's that time of the year when everyone wants to be close to the players, and if they have their way, they can just go on and on with selfies and autographs. But we need to ensure that we start the game on time," a security personnel said in jest.

Of ladybirds and stoppages

The extreme heat on the opening day led to an influx of ladybirds at Lord's, causing a brief pause in play. Things got disruptive enough that England captain Ben Stokes had a word with the on-field umpires — Paul Reiffel and Sharfuddoula Saikat — about whether to continue.

Though play resumed shortly, England vice-captain Ollie Pope admitted he had never seen anything like it. Groundstaff attributed the incident to changing weather conditions. According to them, over the past couple of years, such influxes have become more common across England due to extreme weather.

Bumrah's shoes

Jasprit Bumrah donated his shoes to the MCC Museum following his five-wicket haul in the first innings. The shoes are now displayed in the upper tier of the museum, alongside kits used by legends of the game. While Bumrah kept the match ball, the signed shoes were donated after the third day's play. As he claimed his 13th five-wicket haul in away Tests — the most by an Indian — and made it to the prestigious Lord's Honours Board, Bumrah said the moment made him happy.

"It's a good thing to come to the

Honours Board. When my son grows up, I can tell him that my name is on the Honours Board and it is also on many other places," Bumrah said.

Shayan Acharya

Of mistaken identity and fleeting fame

Who doesn't like being famous? The Diary is no exception. Once during a cricket tour of Bangladesh in late 2022, the Diary was travelling with a very capable YouTuber who had fans even in Dhaka. Two students from Assam, studying medicine in the Bangladeshi capital, came to meet him after watching his shows. The Diary, having spent over a decade in journalism without anyone batting an eyelid at the mention of its name, was

understandably bemused.

So when taxi driver Haneef in Birmingham looked wide-eyed as the Diary entered his car en route to Edgbaston one morning, it was perplexing. Haneef stared at his phone, displaying the ride details, then at the Diary again, still in disbelief. The Diary, running late, asked him to hurry. That's when the driver's demeanour changed. "Oh! You are a reporter... I thought you were Sai Sudharsan," he said.

"What's in a name?" Shakespeare once asked. Well... quite a bit. Momentary fame and a potential ticket to fake stardom, perhaps, for the Diary!



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